



Be aware of your self-care on the flight. Rest make sure you get up regularly to stretch your legs. It's even more important to keep the blood circulating when you're pregnant. Drink plenty of water to avoid dehydration.

BREATHE EASY

Exercise can help keep breathlessness at bay, and increase the efficiency of your heart and lungs (cardiovascular system), helping you to deal with the physical demands of pregnancy now and in later months.

A cardiovascular workout involves increasing your heart rate for at least 20–30 minutes. However, pregnancy is not a time to start training for a marathon; stick to moderate-intensity workouts. A way to test if you are exercising at the right level is to talk while you are working out (see [The impact of exercise on labor](#))—if you can't, lower the intensity.

Try doing interval training, which involves alternating five minutes of cardiovascular workouts with five minutes of toning for the upper body (see [A safe workout](#)). Breathe in to begin and exhale as you lift the weights.

Breathing deeply allows oxygen to travel to your vital organs and helps the cardiovascular system to function effectively. During pregnancy, avoid taking short, shallow breaths. Focus on expanding your rib cage and filling your lungs with air by breathing deeply.